

The 0–27–0 Generative Cycle: A Structural Model of Emergence and Appearance in D/E/S Field Theory (0S–27S)

*Structural Overview of the Appearance / Experience Layer in the WGS
Architecture*

With Directional Polarity (– / +) for Every Level

Wujie Gu

Wujie Generation Stratum (WGS) Project

2026

License: CC BY-NC-ND 4.0 — Non-Commercial, No Derivatives

Abstract

This paper presents the Appearance Spectrum—the S-layer of the Wujie Generation Stratum (WGS) framework, designated 0S through 27S—as the complete arc of visible appearance and experience. The S-layer is the only visible layer in the WGS three-layer architecture. The Dimension layer (D) generates invisible structure; the Emanation layer (E) generates invisible inner activity; the Stratum layer (S) is what actually appears, formally defined as $S = \Delta(D, E)$ —the stable mismatch between structure and inner activity.

The 0S–27S arc runs from the total absence of appearance (Zero Appearance, 0S) through contrast, object-formation, causality, narrative, identity, and meaning, to the fully expressed closure of appearance (27S). 0S is not a marginal starting condition but the structural ground of the entire arc: it is the state in which no mismatch has yet opened, $S = 0$, and the world has not yet shown up. Every S-level expresses a directional polarity—a (–) pole and a (+) pole—because appearance, as a mismatch structure, is inherently two-sided. The paper establishes both the individual character of each level and the global architecture of the arc. The tri-layer principle throughout is: D generates structure, E generates inner activity, S generates appearance.

1. Introduction: The Role of Appearance

In the WGS three-layer ontology, the S-layer occupies a unique structural position: it is the only layer that is visible. Everything that appears—every object, every event, every experiential quality, every world—belongs to S. The Dimension layer (D) and the Emanation layer (E) are both invisible, operating beneath the threshold of appearance as the structural ground and the inner-activity modulation respectively. The Stratum layer (S) is the outcome of their interaction: the stable, visible mismatch that constitutes the world as it shows up.

This structural position has a precise consequence for how the S-layer must be understood. S is not a further layer of processing that produces something else; it is the terminal layer, the layer at which the generative process becomes world. To be an S-level configuration is to be something that appears—an object, a temporal flow, a causal connection, a narrative arc, an identity, a meaning. The 0S–27S arc is therefore not a sequence of intermediate steps toward appearance but the complete structure of appearance itself, from its total absence (0S) to its total expression (27S).

A second structural consequence follows from the definition $S = \Delta(D, E)$: appearance is inherently two-sided. A mismatch between two structures always has two directional poles—the asserting direction and the receding direction, the + pole and the – pole. Every S-level therefore expresses a directional polarity: two mutually defining sides of the same appearance-structure, neither of which can exist without the other. This bipolarity is a structural consequence of what appearance is, not a cultural or cosmological attribution.

2. Methodology: Appearance Logic

2.1 The Tri-Layer Principle

The organizing principle of this paper is the WGS tri-layer distinction. D is the structural layer: non-phenomenal, invisible, the generative ground that produces tension, identity, mapping, and closure. E is the inner-activity layer: non-phenomenal, invisible, the

domain of emotion, intention, valuation, identity-formation, and inner closure that modulates structural signals. S is the appearance layer: phenomenal, visible, the only layer that shows up as world. The formal relationship among them is $S = \Delta(D, E)$: appearance is the stable mismatch between structure and inner activity.

This principle governs the treatment of each S-level throughout the paper. Psychological descriptions (which belong to E) are excluded from the characterization of S-levels. Metaphysical descriptions (which belong to D) are equally excluded. What is described at each S-level is strictly the appearance-structure: what shows up, how it shows up, and what structural role it plays in the arc from 0S to 27S.

2.2 The Generative Sequence of Appearance

The 0S–27S arc follows a generative sequence in which each level is structurally conditioned by the prior levels. The sequence at a high level of abstraction:

Zero (0S) → Flicker (1S) → Contrast (2S) → Object (3S) → Time (4S) → Actuality (5S) → Causality (6S) → Field (7S) → Stable Object (8S) → Law (9S) → Other-Agent (10S) → System (11S) → Appearance-Law (12S) → Multi-Scale (13S) → Cross-Scale Identity (14S) → Unified World (15S) → Global Coherence (16S) → Narrative (17S) → Agency (18S) → Intention (19S) → Value (20S) → Identity (21S) → Meaning (22S) → Meta-Meaning (23S) → Worldview (24S) → Framework-Shift (25S) → Self-Modification (26S) → Closure (27S).

Each level in this sequence requires the prior levels as its structural condition. Causality (6S) cannot appear without temporal flow (4S) and actuality (5S). Identity (21S) cannot appear without stable objects (8S), multi-agent worlds (10S), and agentive self-origination (18S). The sequence is both a taxonomy and an explanation.

2.3 Methodological Constraints

Three constraints govern the treatment throughout. First, no phenomenology: the paper describes structural roles and generative functions of S-levels, not the qualitative character of subjective experience. Second, no psychology: psychological descriptions (which belong to the E-layer of inner activity) are excluded. Third, no metaphysics:

structural claims about the D-layer ground are excluded. The paper remains at the level of appearance-structure: what appears, what structural function it serves, and how it is directionally polarized.

3. Architecture of the Appearance Layer

3.1 What Appearance Is

Appearance is the visible world, considered as a structured totality. Everything that shows up as world belongs to S: objects and their properties, temporal flow, spatial fields, causal connections, narrative sequences, social realities, agentic presences, values, meanings, and worldviews. Appearance is not a copy of structure (D) and not an expression of inner activity (E); it is the third thing that arises when structure and inner activity are jointly present and structurally misaligned. $S = \Delta(D, E)$ means that appearance is precisely the gap between structure and inner activity—the stable, visible form of their non-identity.

This has an important consequence: appearance is not derivable from either D or E alone. Knowing the full D-level structural configuration does not determine what appears, because appearance also depends on the E-level inner-activity configuration. And knowing the full E-level inner-activity configuration does not determine what appears, because appearance also depends on the D-level structural ground. S is irreducible to either of its generating layers.

3.2 0S: The Ground of the Arc

The arc does not begin at 1S. It begins at 0S—Zero Appearance—the structural ground from which all appearance emerges. 0S is the state in which no mismatch has yet opened: $S = 0$, and no world shows up. It is not a vacuum in the physical sense but the structural absence of appearance—the condition prior to the first contrast, the first flicker, the first anything. No objects, no temporal flow, no causality, no agents, no meanings: the differentiation index is zero.

0S is structurally active, not merely an absence. It is the condition that *contains*, in structural potentiality, the entire arc that follows. The + pole of 0S is this latent potential—the structural availability for appearance to begin, for the first mismatch to open. The – pole is pure emptiness—the absence of all appearance as such. Without 0S as the grounded starting condition, the arc has no coherent origin.

3.3 Why 0S–27S Is Closed

The closure of the appearance arc follows from the structural fact that 0S and 27S are not merely opposite ends of a spectrum but two aspects of the same closure condition. 0S is the absence of all appearance: no mismatch has opened, $S = 0$. 27S is the full expression of appearance: the mismatch has been fully elaborated through all 27 structural levels, the world has said everything it has to say.

At the boundary, the directional poles invert: the + pole of 27S (full manifestation) is structurally identical to the – pole of 0S (pure emptiness); the – pole of 27S (return-to-zero potential) is structurally identical to the + pole of 0S (latent potential). The cycle closes not by identical repetition but by directional inversion at the boundary: 27S's + pole = 0S's – pole; 27S's – pole = 0S's + pole.

3.4 Relation to D and E

The appearance arc stands in a specific structural relationship to each of the other two layers. With respect to D: every S-level appearance has a corresponding D-level structural configuration that is its generative ground. The temporal appearance of 4S has D4 (the state-transition structure) as its structural basis; the causal appearance of 6S has D6 (the selection mechanism) as its basis. But the S-level appearance is not the D-level structure; it is the appearance of that structure as mediated by the E-level inner activity.

With respect to E: every S-level appearance has a corresponding E-level inner-activity configuration that shapes its character. The agency appearance of 18S is the appearance of what E18 (Inner Agency) is inwardly; the meaning appearance of 22S is the appearance of what E22 (Inner Meaning) organizes inwardly. But the S-level appearance is

not the E-level inner activity; it is the visible face of the inner activity's divergence from structural ground.

4. The Appearance Spectrum (0S–27S) with Directional Polarity

The following sections characterize each S-level by its appearance role, structural function, generative rule, relation to adjacent levels, and directional polarity. The polarity at each level designates the two structural poles of the appearance-mismatch: the (–) pole and the (+) pole. Neither pole is more real or more primary; they are the two sides of the same mismatch, mutually defining.

4.1 0S — Zero Appearance

– pole: 空(*empty / pure absence*) + pole: 潜在性(*latent potential*)

0S is the structural ground of the appearance arc: the condition in which no mismatch has opened, $S = 0$, and no world shows up. It is not a vacuum in the physical sense but the structural absence of appearance—the condition prior to the first contrast, the first flicker, the first anything. There are no objects at 0S, no temporal flow, no causality, no agents, no meanings. The differentiation index is zero: no distinctions have been drawn.

The – pole of 0S is pure emptiness: the absence of all appearance. The + pole is latent potential: the structural availability for appearance to begin, the capacity for the first mismatch to open. 0S is therefore not simply nothing; it is the structured ground of nothing, the condition that contains, in structural potentiality, the entire arc that follows.

The boundary relation between 0S and 27S is the structural heart of the WGS cycle. The + pole of 0S (latent potential) is structurally identical to the – pole of 27S (return-to-zero). The – pole of 0S (pure emptiness) is structurally identical to the + pole of 27S (full manifestation). The cycle closes by directional inversion at this boundary.

4.2 1S — Minimal Flicker Appearance

– pole: 灌(*extinguish*) + pole: 閃(*flash*)

1S is the first departure from zero appearance: a barely-there flicker of visibility, not yet a thing, not yet differentiated into any quality, but no longer the pure absence of 0S. Something appears—minimally, transiently, without character or persistence. The structural condition is the opening of the first mismatch: $\Delta(D, E) \neq 0$ for the first time, but the mismatch is at its minimum.

The – pole is extinguishing: the aspect of the flicker that vanishes immediately, collapsing back toward the 0S ground before any contrast can stabilize. The + pole is flashing: the aspect that briefly asserts itself, introducing the first visible deviation from nothing. The 1S appearance is the alternation between these two poles—a minimal oscillation at the threshold of visibility.

4.3 2S — Contrast Appearance

– pole: 暗(*dark*) + pole: 明(*light*)

2S is the appearance of difference: light and dark, near and far, presence and absence, more and less. No objects have yet appeared at 2S—contrast is not yet objecthood—but the world now has differentiability. For the first time, one region of the appearance field is distinguishable from another. This is the structural precondition for all subsequent appearance: every boundary, every edge, every distinction in higher S-levels has its appearance-ground in the contrast structure established at 2S.

The – pole is darkness: the receding side of the contrast, the region of lesser presence, the ‘nothing’ against which the ‘something’ of the + pole appears. The + pole is light: the asserted side, the region of greater presence. The contrast at 2S is not yet qualitatively specified; it is the bare structural fact of difference, the root of all subsequent distinction.

4.4 3S — Proto-Object Appearance

– pole: 无形(*formless*) + pole: 形(*form*)

3S is the minimal world-threshold: the first appearance of a stable something, a proto-object, a thing-sense. The contrast of 2S has now stabilized into a recognizable

configuration—not yet a determinate object with properties, but the first coherent appearance-unit that persists across the rendering cycle rather than dissolving immediately back into contrast. This is the minimal world: the earliest point at which a world can be said to exist.

The + pole is form: the asserted presence of the proto-object, its minimal shape and boundary. The – pole is formlessness: the surrounding field against which form appears, the undifferentiated background from which the proto-object has emerged. Form and formlessness are mutually defining at 3S: neither can appear without the other.

4.5 4S — Temporal Appearance

– pole: 后(after) + pole: 前(before)

4S is the appearance of time: before and after, flow, unfolding, the sense that the world is not static but moving. Events begin to appear as sequences rather than simultaneous configurations. The proto-objects of 3S acquire a temporal dimension; they can now change, persist, and succeed one another. Without 4S, the appearance arc would be frozen—a static contrast field with proto-objects but no movement, no process, no becoming.

The + pole is ‘before’: the direction of origination, the past as the source from which the present has come. The – pole is ‘after’: the direction of completion, the future as the destination toward which the present moves. The temporal appearance at 4S is the alternation between these two poles—the asymmetric flow that gives the world its directional character.

4.6 5S — Actuality Appearance

– pole: 虚(possible / unactualized) + pole: 实(actual)

5S is the appearance of determinacy: the world appears as ‘this path and not others,’ as a single coherent timeline rather than a field of branching possibilities. The temporal flow of 4S has been resolved into an actualized sequence. What has happened

has happened; the unchosen possibilities have receded into the background of the virtual. The world appears as real rather than merely possible.

The + pole is actuality: the asserted, real, ‘this is what happened’ character of experience. The – pole is possibility/virtuality: the field of what might have been but did not, the unchosen alternatives that define the actual by contrast. Actuality without virtuality would be a world with no sense of contingency; virtuality without actuality would be a world of pure indetermination.

4.7 6S — Causal Appearance

– pole: 果(effect) + pole: 因(cause)

6S is the appearance of causal connection: events appear to follow from prior events, effects appear to be produced by causes, the world gains visible directionality and constraint. The actualized timeline of 5S is now not merely a sequence of events but a causally ordered sequence in which prior states visibly constrain subsequent ones. This is the appearance-ground of physical law, of inference, of explanation.

The + pole is cause: the originating side of the causal connection, the event that produces. The – pole is effect: the produced side, the event that results. Cause and effect are not symmetric—cause has structural priority, effect has structural posteriority—which is why the temporal arrow of 4S and the causal direction of 6S are aligned.

4.8 7S — Field Appearance

– pole: 外(outside) + pole: 内(inside)

7S is the appearance of spatial field: distance, location, direction, and the interactions that occur across distance. The world at 7S appears as a field—a structured space in which entities exist at positions and interact across those positions. Boundaries appear in the proper sense: the interface between one entity and another, the surface that both separates and connects. This is the appearance-ground of space.

The + pole is inside: the interior of a bounded region, the contained, the self-enclosed. The – pole is outside: the exterior, the environment, the relational field that

surrounds. Inside and outside are mutually defining: there is no inside without an outside that defines it by contrast, and no outside without the inside it surrounds.

4.9 8S — Object Appearance

– pole: 非物(*non-object*) + pole: 物(*object*)

8S is the appearance of stable objects: entities that persist through time, maintain their identity across interactions, and constitute the recognizable furniture of the world. Where 3S introduced the proto-object—a minimal thing-sense without stability— 8S introduces the full object: a pattern that endures, that is the same thing before and after an interaction, that can be named and re-encountered. The world at 8S is no longer a field of events but a field of things.

The + pole is object: the persistent, nameable, re-identifiable entity. The – pole is non-object: the processes, relations, fields, and events that are not themselves things but that objects are embedded in and constituted by. A world of pure objects would be static and relationless; a world of pure non-objects would have nothing stable to relate.

4.10 9S — Lawful Appearance

– pole: 例外(*exception*) + pole: 规律(*regularity*)

9S is the appearance of lawfulness: the world looks governed by consistent rules, patterns repeat, regularities are visible, and the behavior of objects is predictable. This is the appearance-ground of physical law, of science, of any practice that depends on the world's regularities being accessible and reliable. The 9S appearance is not a claim about the D-level structural rules (which are invisible) but their visible expression in the S-layer: the world as it appears regular.

The + pole is regularity: the lawful, the predictable, the pattern that repeats. The – pole is exception: the deviation, the anomaly, the event that falls outside the regular pattern. Regularity and exception are mutually defining: there is no regularity without the possibility of exception, and there is no exception without the regularity it departs from.

4.11 10S — Multi-Agent Appearance

– pole: 他者 (*other*) + pole: 自者 (*self*)

10S is the appearance of others: the world contains not merely objects and processes but other agents—entities that are not merely things but centers of perspective, action, and experience. The social world begins at 10S. Objects (8S) are stable but passive; others (10S) are active, perspectival, and irreducible to the physical regularities of 9S. The appearance of the other is the appearance of a center of world-formation analogous to one's own.

The + pole is self: the first-person center of the world, the 'I' from whose perspective the world is organized. The – pole is other: the second- and third-person centers, the others whose perspectives differ from and exceed the self's. Self and other are mutually defining: there is no self that is not defined by contrast with others, and no other that is not encountered from a self-position.

4.12 11S — Coordination Appearance

– pole: 变 (*variable / changing*) + pole: 稳 (*stable*)

11S is the appearance of coordinated systems: the world appears self-consistent, feedback loops are visible, the multiple agents of 10S appear to operate within a framework that sustains overall coherence. Systems at 11S appear to regulate themselves: they maintain equilibrium, respond to perturbation, and exhibit the kind of organized behavior that distinguishes a system from a mere collection. This is the appearance-ground of ecology, of social organization, of dynamic equilibrium.

The + pole is stability: the maintained equilibrium, the system that holds its pattern against perturbation. The – pole is variability: the perturbation, the change, the fluctuation that the stable system responds to and incorporates. A system that never varies is not stable but frozen; a system that never stabilizes is not variable but chaotic.

4.13 12S — Rendering-Law Appearance

– pole: 隱 (*hidden*) + pole: 显 (*visible / manifest*)

12S is structurally distinctive: it is the appearance of the laws of appearance itself. Not the laws governing objects (9S) but the meta-level regularity that governs how the world shows up at all—the consistent conditions of visibility that make 0S–11S possible and intelligible as a coherent arc. The world at 12S appears to have rules not just within it but governing how it appears. This is the appearance-ground of coherent experience as such.

The + pole is manifest: that which has come into visibility, the rule of appearance as expressed in the visible world. The – pole is hidden: the structural conditions of appearance that are operative but not themselves directly visible—the ‘rules behind the rules.’ Manifest and hidden are complementary: every visible regularity conceals the deeper conditions that make it possible, and every hidden condition expresses itself through visible regularities.

4.14 13S — Multi-Scale Appearance

– pole: 小 (*small*) + pole: 大 (*large*)

13S is the appearance of nested structure: the world appears simultaneously at multiple scales, from the microscopic to the macroscopic, each scale with its own visible character, neither reducible to the other. The world at 13S has depth in the scale dimension: zooming in reveals different structure than zooming out, and both are genuine aspects of the same world. This is the appearance-ground of hierarchical organization.

The + pole is large: the macro-scale, the global, the view from above. The – pole is small: the micro-scale, the local, the view from within. Large and small are structural poles: the global context that constrains local behavior and the local content that constitutes global patterns are mutually necessary aspects of the multi-scale world.

4.15 14S — Cross-Scale Identity Appearance

– pole: 异 (*different*) + pole: 同 (*same*)

14S is the appearance of consistency across scales: the same entity remains recognizably itself whether viewed at the microscopic or macroscopic level. The multi-

scale world of 13S has now acquired an identity structure that spans its scales: things are not merely differently described at different scales but are visibly the same things seen from different distances. This is the appearance-ground of the unity of scientific explanation across levels of organization.

The + pole is sameness: the identity that persists across scale-differences, the ‘it is still the same thing’ that makes cross-scale recognition possible. The – pole is difference: the genuine scale-specific character that makes each level of description genuinely distinct. Without sameness, there is no cross-scale identity; without difference, there is no cross-scale structure.

4.16 15S — Unified World Appearance

– pole: 多 (*many*) + pole: 一 (*one*)

15S is the appearance of world-unity: despite the multiplicity of agents, perspectives, scales, and structural levels, the world appears as one world. This is the phenomenological sense of being in a shared reality, the structural foundation of intersubjective agreement and common reference. The world at 15S is not a collection of separate appearance-fragments but a unified field that all of its inhabitants occupy simultaneously from their respective positions.

The + pole is oneness: the integrated world-body, the ‘one world’ that all the multiplicity belongs to. The – pole is multiplicity: the genuine plurality of agents, scales, perspectives, and events that constitute the world’s richness. Oneness without multiplicity would be a featureless unity; multiplicity without oneness would be a disconnected plurality.

4.17 16S — Global Coherence Appearance

– pole: 部分 (*part*) + pole: 整体 (*whole*)

16S is the appearance of the world as a totality with global structure. Where 15S established unity (the world as one), 16S establishes wholeness (the world as an organized whole with global coherence). The parts of the world at 16S appear as genuine parts of an

organized whole, not merely as elements of a collection. The world appears cosmic in scope: structured, coherent, and complete as a totality. This is the appearance-ground of cosmological thinking.

The + pole is whole: the global structure, the organized totality, the world considered in its comprehensive unity. The – pole is part: the local element, the specific region, the individual event considered in its particularity. Whole and part are mutually defining: there is no whole without parts that constitute it, and no parts without a whole that they belong to.

4.18 17S — Narrative Appearance

– pole: 终(ending) + pole: 始(beginning)

17S is the appearance of narrative structure: events appear not merely as a causal sequence (6S) but as a story with direction, development, and the structural possibility of completion. The world at 17S has the character of unfolding: it appears to be going somewhere, to have a trajectory that has a beginning, a middle, and an end. This is the appearance-ground of history, of biography, of any experience that has the shape of a story.

The + pole is beginning: the moment of origination, the ‘once upon a time’ from which the narrative departs. The – pole is ending: the moment of completion, the ‘and then’ that brings the narrative to its close. Beginning and ending are not symmetric: the beginning has structural priority (narrative unfolds from it) while the ending has hermeneutic priority (the narrative is understood in retrospect from its ending).

4.19 18S — Agency Appearance

– pole: 不能(cannot) + pole: 能(can)

18S is the appearance of agency: actions appear to originate from within agents rather than merely to result from prior causes. The world at 18S contains visible will—the appearance of self-origination, of initiative, of a structural center from which action issues. This is the appearance-ground of freedom, of responsibility, of the distinction between

acting and merely happening. The agent at 18S appears as a source of action, not merely a conduit.

The + pole is capacity: the ability to act, the ‘I can’ that is the structural condition of agentive self-origination. The – pole is incapacity: the inability to act, the constraint that defines the boundary of agentive freedom. There is no agency that is not defined by its limits, and there are no meaningful limits without an agency that encounters them.

4.20 19S — Intention Appearance

– pole: 反向 (*counter-directed / away from*) + pole: 向 (*toward / directed*)

19S is the appearance of directedness: actions appear purposeful, oriented toward a goal or state. The agency of 18S was the appearance of self-origination without specified direction; the intention of 19S adds the appearance of a target—the ‘toward’ that gives agentive action its teleological character. The world at 19S contains visible purposes: processes that appear to be not merely happening but aiming.

The + pole is directedness: the orientation toward a goal, the ‘about-to’ or ‘in-order-to’ character of intentional action. The – pole is counter-directedness: the resistance, the obstacle, the force that opposes the intended direction. Intention is only visible against the background of possible resistance, and resistance is only meaningful against the background of a direction it opposes.

4.21 20S — Value Appearance

– pole: 低价值 / 恶 (*lower value / ill*) + pole: 高价值 / 善 (*higher value / good*)

20S is the appearance of value: the world appears structured by importance, by better and worse, by preference and aversion. Things matter at 20S; the world has visible stakes. This is the appearance-ground of ethics, of aesthetics, of any experience in which the concept of value is operative as a structural rather than merely conventional category. The appearance of value is not a subjective overlay on a value-neutral world but a genuine S-level structural feature: the world shows up as mattering.

The + pole is the good: the high-value direction, what is preferred, what appears better. The – pole is the ill or lower value: the low-value direction, what is avoided, what appears worse. The value poles are not symmetric in their experiential character—the good draws and the ill repels—but they are structurally symmetric: neither pole is intelligible without the other.

4.22 21S — Identity Appearance

– pole: 非我 (*non-self*) + pole: 我 (*self*)

21S is the appearance of stable personal identity: the world contains subjects who appear to themselves and to others as continuous identities across time. The agents of 18S were self-originating but not yet autobiographically continuous; the values of 20S were operative but not yet organized around a stable self that holds them. At 21S, the self appears as such—as a persistent ‘I’ that recognizes itself across contexts, that has a history and a character that are its own.

The + pole is self: the first-person identity, the ‘I’ as a stable structural presence in the world. The – pole is non-self: the other-as-other, the world-as-not-I, the alterity that defines the self by contrast. The self appears only against the background of what it is not, and the non-self is only coherent as what stands over against the self.

4.23 22S — Meaning Appearance

– pole: 无义 (*meaningless*) + pole: 有义 (*meaningful*)

22S is the appearance of significance: events appear not merely as happening but as mattering in a deeper sense—as significant, as pointing beyond themselves, as bearing a weight that exceeds their bare occurrence. Meaning-appearance is not the same as value-appearance (20S): values tell us what is better or worse; meanings tell us what is significant, what belongs to a larger interpretive framework, what is worth understanding rather than merely preferring. The world at 22S is a world of significance-relations.

The + pole is meaningfulness: the appearance of significance, the sense that an event matters, that it points beyond itself. The – pole is meaninglessness: the appearance

of insignificance, the sense that an event is arbitrary, disconnected, without significance-relation. Meaningfulness and meaninglessness together constitute the meaning-field of the world: neither is the default, both are genuine S-level appearances.

4.24 23S — Meta-Meaning Appearance

– pole: 反意 (*counter-meaning / negation*) + pole: 正意 (*affirmative meaning*)

23S is the appearance of meaning about meaning: the world contains not merely meaningful events but the visible structure of interpretation itself. At 23S, the framework through which meaning is assigned becomes itself an object of the world—interpretive frameworks appear as such, the question of what something means becomes itself a meaningful question, and the world contains the visible possibility of re-interpretation. This is the appearance-ground of philosophy, hermeneutics, and any reflective engagement with meaning.

The + pole is affirmative meaning: the meaning that affirms, that says ‘yes’ to the interpretive framework, that takes a framework as adequate and applies it. The – pole is counter-meaning: the meaning that negates, that questions the framework, that introduces the possibility of alternative interpretation. Affirmation and negation at the meta-meaning level are the structural poles of reflective engagement with meaning.

4.25 24S — Worldview Appearance

– pole: 非 (*no / not*) + pole: 是 (*yes / is*)

24S is the appearance of a worldview: a coherent total interpretation of the world that integrates value (20S), identity (21S), meaning (22S), and reflective meaning (23S) into a single unified framework through which the world appears as a whole that can be understood. The worldview-appearance is not a collection of beliefs but a structural presentation of how things are—a globally coherent interpretive framework that organizes all lower-level appearances into a unified picture.

The + pole is affirmation: the ‘yes’ of the worldview, its positive assertions about how things are, its picture of reality as it affirms it. The – pole is negation: the ‘no’ of the

worldview, its rejections, its picture of what is not the case. Every coherent worldview is constituted by both its affirmations and its negations: what it says yes to defines its positive content, and what it says no to defines its boundaries.

4.26 25S — Framework-Shift Appearance

– pole: 出框(out-of-frame) + pole: 在框(in-frame)

25S is the appearance of the possibility of reframing: the world appears as something whose interpretive framework can be revised from within. At 24S the world appeared through a worldview; at 25S the worldview itself appears as revisable, as one possible interpretive configuration among others. The world contains the visible possibility of stepping outside one’s current framework and adopting a different one. This is the appearance-ground of philosophical revision, spiritual transformation, and paradigm shifts.

The + pole is in-frame: the appearance of the world from within a current interpretive framework, the world as organized and familiar, the ‘this is how things are’ of settled interpretation. The – pole is out-of-frame: the appearance of the world from a position that exceeds the current framework, the disorienting visibility of the framework itself as a framework, the ‘this could be otherwise.’

4.27 26S — Self-Modification Appearance

– pole: 新(new) + pole: 旧(old)

26S is the appearance of radical self-revision: the world appears capable of modifying the conditions of its own appearance. At 25S, interpretive frameworks appeared revisable; at 26S, the structural conditions under which any framework operates appear revisable. The world contains the appearance of genuine self-transformation—not merely changing one’s beliefs or framework (25S) but revising the structural ground on which all frameworks stand. This is the appearance-ground of the deepest levels of personal and collective transformation.

The + pole is old: the prior structural configuration, the existing self, the world as it was before self-modification. The – pole is new: the post-modification configuration, the revised self, the world as it has become through self-modification. Old and new are not symmetric in their experiential weight: the new emerges from the old and carries it as its history, while the old appears retrospectively in the light of the new.

4.28 27S — Closure Appearance

– pole: 空(*empty, with potential to fold back*) + pole: 满(*full / complete manifestation*)

27S is the final and closing level of the appearance arc: the world appears fully expressed, the generative cycle has been fully traversed, the appearance arc has said everything it has to say. Nothing further remains to emerge within the conditioned domain; the world-appearance has achieved its structural completion. The world-feeling of 27S is the appearance of completion—not emptiness, not dissolution, but the felt sense of a generative cycle that has arrived at its structural endpoint.

The + pole of 27S is fullness: complete manifestation, the maximal expression of world-appearance. This + pole is structurally identical to the – pole of 0S (pure emptiness)—the fully expressed is what the pure-empty becomes when it has been completely articulated. The – pole of 27S is the return-to-zero potential: the latent capacity for the cycle to begin again, the structural openness of the fully expressed to its own dissolution back into ground. This – pole is structurally identical to the + pole of 0S (latent potential).

The cycle is therefore closed by directional inversion: 27S's + pole = 0S's – pole; 27S's – pole = 0S's + pole. The end and the beginning are the same structural condition, approached from opposite directions.

5. Global Patterns of the Appearance Spectrum

5.1 The Structural Arc

The 0S–27S arc exhibits a four-phase structure. The foundational phase (0S–3S) establishes the minimal conditions for appearance: the pre-world ground (0S), the first visible flicker (1S), the contrast that makes all distinction possible (2S), and the proto-object that crosses the world-threshold (3S). The physical phase (4S–9S) develops the temporal, causal, spatial, object, and lawful structures that constitute the basic visible character of the world. The social-agentive phase (10S–21S) elaborates the higher-order appearances: other agents, coordinated systems, multi-scale structure, world-unity, narrative, agency, intention, value, and stable identity. The reflective-closure phase (22S–27S) completes the arc through meaning, meta-meaning, worldview, framework-revision, self-modification, and structural closure.

5.2 The Symmetry Between 0S and 27S

The boundary symmetry of the arc is the structural signature of its closure. 0S is the appearance of nothing: no contrast, no object, no time, no causality, no agent, no meaning—but the latent potential for all of these (+ pole of 0S). 27S is the appearance of everything: all of the above levels have been traversed, the world has fully expressed its generative content—but now contains the return-to-zero potential as its own – pole. The directional poles invert at the boundary: the + pole of 0S (latent potential) = the – pole of 27S (return-to-zero); the – pole of 0S (pure emptiness) = the + pole of 27S (full manifestation). The cycle is closed.

5.3 Appearance as $S = \Delta(D, E)$

Every S-level appearance is a mismatch between a D-level structural configuration and an E-level inner-activity configuration. The directional polarity at each level reflects the structure of this mismatch: the two poles are the two sides of the divergence between structure and inner activity, the two ways in which the mismatch can be directionally characterized. A world that has traversed the full 0S–27S arc has, at each level, expressed the two-sided character of the mismatch that constitutes it as a world.

6. Implications of the Appearance Spectrum

6.1 Why Appearance Is Necessary

The S-layer is the completion of the WGS generative process. The D-layer generates structural conditions that are real but invisible; the E-layer generates inner-activity that is real but invisible; without the S-layer, the D/E system would be generatively complete but phenomenally absent. Appearance is necessary because a world that never shows up—that generates structure and inner activity but produces no visible presence, no object, no event, no meaning—is not a world in any sense that includes experience. The S-layer is the layer at which the generative process becomes world-for-someone, world-as-encountered, world-as-lived.

6.2 Interface with the E-Layer

Every S-level appearance has a corresponding E-level inner-activity configuration that is its invisible interior. The directional polarity at each S-level reflects the corresponding directional structure in the E-level inner activity: the (+) pole of S-appearance corresponds to the assertive, directed direction of E-level inner activity; the (–) pole of S-appearance corresponds to the receding, returning direction. The two layers are not in one-to-one correspondence at every specific point, but their structural directionalities are aligned: the S-layer’s directional structure is the visible expression of the E-layer’s inner-activity direction.

6.3 Interface with the D-Layer

Every S-level appearance has a corresponding D-level structural configuration that is its invisible ground. The D-layer determines the structural content that appears at each S-level: the temporal structure that appears at 4S derives from the D4 state-transition architecture; the causal structure that appears at 6S derives from the D6 selection mechanism; the identity structure that appears at 21S derives from the D21 stable-identity configuration. The S-layer does not reproduce the D-layer—appearance is not structure—

but each S-level expresses the D-level content that is its structural source, mediated through the E-level inner activity that generates the mismatch.

7. Conclusion

The Appearance Spectrum from 0S to 27S constitutes the complete visible-world architecture of the WGS framework. It runs from the pre-world ground of Zero Appearance (0S)—where no mismatch has opened and no world shows up—through the full elaboration of visible world-structure, to the Closure Appearance of 27S, at which the generative arc has reached its complete expression. Every level carries a directional polarity: the two structural poles (– and +) of the mismatch $S = \Delta(D, E)$ that constitutes the appearance at that level. The arc is closed by directional inversion at the boundary: 27S's + pole = 0S's – pole; 27S's – pole = 0S's + pole.

The S-layer is the only visible layer in the WGS architecture. D and E are both invisible—the structural ground and the inner-activity interior of the world. S is the world as it shows up: the appearance of objects, time, causality, agency, meaning, worldview, and self-modification that constitutes the experiential reality in which all of this is encountered. The appearance arc is complete.

The next step in WGS development is the unified D/E/S $\times$ 27 matrix: the full triple-layer mapping that locates each D-level structural configuration, each E-level inner-activity configuration, and each S-level appearance configuration in their mutual structural relationship across all 27 levels simultaneously.

License

This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License (CC BY-NC-ND 4.0), © 2026 Wujie Gu. All rights reserved.

<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/>